ATHLETICS ▼

CHASING GLOBAL GLORY

The previous two editions of the World Athletics Championships have been a happy hunting ground for India, courtesy Neeraj Chopra. Until then, the country's lone medal at the event was Anju Bobby George's long jump bronze in 2003. Chopra took silver in 2022 and bettered it to gold the following year. Come September 13, the javelin throw exponent will be back in the spotlight, a favourite to medal in the 16-member contingent. Here are the top contenders in Japan



ANIMESH KUJUR

The first Indian sprinter to have qualified, Animesh Kujur bettered the national marks for the 100 and 200m—the latter fetching him bronze at the Asian Championships. Finishing just outside of the podium places in the 200m of the under-23 Monaco Diamond League in July, he appears ready to take on the best.

PRAVEEN CHITHRAVEL

After a dismal performance at the 2024 Paris Games, Praveen Chithravel is gradually finding his feet again. In April, he equalled his own triple jump national record of 17.37m, a mark he first achieved two years ago. He has had a good run of results since then, with silver at the Asian Championships and the World University Games.





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NEERAJ CHOPRA

Since the gold at the 2023 World Championships, Neeraj Chopra has annexed an Olympic silver and three second-placed Diamond League finishes. More importantly, he has got the monkey off his back after breaking the 90m barrier at the Doha Diamond League in May. He'll be hungry to continue the same form in Tokyo.